



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE HONOURS

MAJOR

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG4CJ204				
Course Title	LITERARY CRITICISM				
Type of Course	MAJOR				
Semester	IV				
Academic Level	200-299				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	4	4	-	-	60
Pre-requisites	Basic understanding of literary criticism				
Course Summary	This course provides a comprehensive understanding of literary criticism by exploring diverse theoretical perspectives from antiquity to modern times. Learners will delve into pivotal works by influential thinkers, gaining insights into various critical lenses used to analyze literature. Through interactive discussions and activities, learners will enhance their ability to analyze literature from multiple perspectives. The course concludes with a collaborative project where learners apply their acquired knowledge to analyze specific literary works using chosen critical approaches. Upon completion, learners will possess refined analytical skills and a deeper appreciation for the complexities of literature and criticism.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO 1	Demonstrate advanced analytical skills in critically evaluating literary texts, including novels, poems, plays, and essays.	An	C	Essays/ Presentations
CO 2	Ability to interpret and elucidate complex literary works, discerning underlying themes, motifs, and symbolism.	U, Ap	F	Written interpretations/Oral presentations
CO 3	Develop strong research skills, enabling them to conduct in-depth literary analyses, engage with secondary sources, and contribute original insights to the field of literary criticism.	E	C	Critical reviews
CO 4	Cultivate a critical mindset, questioning assumptions, challenging prevailing interpretations, and contributing to ongoing scholarly debates	E, C	C	Discussions
CO 5	Foster cultural sensitivity and awareness, encouraging students to consider the socio-historical contexts in which literary texts are produced and consumed, and to appreciate the diverse perspectives represented in literature.	U, Ap	C	Essays/Presentation
CO 6	Enhance communication skills by articulating their literary analyses coherently and persuasively.	U, Ap	P	Written essays and Oral presentations/ Seminars.
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P). Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs	Marks
I	Foundations of Literary Criticism		15	18
	1	Introduction to Classical Literary Criticism: Rasa, bhava, Rhetoric, Logos, Yugen, Wabi-sabi		
	2	Introduction to Classical Literary Criticism Essential Reading: M. H. Abrams: A Glossary of Literary Terms (focus on terms mimesis, catharsis, and verisimilitude)	3	
	3	Plato's Theory of Mimesis Essential Reading: Plato, Republic (selections from Book X on the nature of art and imitation)	3	
	4	Aristotle: Catharsis Essential Reading: Patricia Waugh, Literary Theory and Criticism, an Oxford Guide (Chapter 1, excerpt on Catharsis)	3	
	5	Dante: Promoting the Vernacular Essential Reading: M. A. R. Habib, A History of Literary Criticism From Plato to the Present (Promoting the Vernacular: Dante's De Vulgari Eloquentia)	3	
	6	Anandavardhana: Dhvani Essential Reading: Neeraja A. Gupta, Dhvani: A Historical Overview (focus on the concept of dhvani or suggestion in Indian aesthetics)	3	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Analyze a classic text (e.g., Oedipus Rex) applying Aristotelian elements of plot, character, and theme. 2. Group activity: Analyze a poem using the concept of Dhvani or suggestion. 3. Watch a Noh play (e.g- https://youtu.be/YVARAMARvk8?si=Zkh7hS74fT_dWSQn) and compare it with a traditional theatre performance in your region.		
II	Neoclassical Criticism and the age of Enlightenment		12	17
	7	The Rise of Neoclassicism Essential Reading: M. A. R. Habib, A History of Literary Criticism From Plato to the Present (Chapter 12, excerpt on Neoclassicism)	4	
	8	John Dryden Essential Reading: M. A. R. Habib, A History of Literary Criticism From Plato to the Present (Chapter 12, excerpt on Neoclassicism)	4	
	9	David Hume Essential Reading: David Hume, "Of the Standard of Taste" (from Four Dissertations)	4	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Class debate: David Hume is right, taste is subjective.		

III	Romanticism and the Rise of Modern Criticism		12	17
	10	Introduction to Romanticism Essential Reading: M. A. R. Habib, A History of Literary Criticism From Plato to the Present (Chapter 17 on Romanticism in England)	3	
	11	Samuel Taylor Coleridge Essential Reading: Samuel Taylor Coleridge, Biographia Literaria (excerpts on imagination and fancy)	3	
	12	Ralph Waldo Emerson Essential Reading: Ralph Waldo Emerson, "The Poet" (Excerpts)	3	
	13	Matthew Arnold Essential Reading: M. A. R. Habib, A History of Literary Criticism From Plato to the Present (Excerpt "Matthew Arnold")	3	
	14	Leo Tolstoy Essential Reading: Leo Tolstoy, "What is Art?" (excerpt on the purpose and definition of art)	3	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Class discussion on the characteristics of Romanticism with reference to "Ode to a Nightingale" by John Keats. 2. Research project: Choose a Romantic era artist (e.g., William Blake) and analyze their work through a Romantic lens.		
IV	Delving into Modernity		9	18
	15	T. S. Eliot: Impersonality theory Essential Reading: T. S. Eliot, "Tradition and the Individual Talent" (excerpt on the concept of the "individual talent")	3	
	16	New Criticism Essential Reading: Stephen Matterson, "New Criticism" (from Literary Theory and Criticism, an Oxford Guide by Patricia Waugh, Chapter 12, excerpt on methods and characteristics)	2	
	17	Wimsatt and Beardsley Essential Reading: W. K. Wimsatt and Monroe C. Beardsley, "The Intentional Fallacy"	2	
	18	Sigmund Freud Essential Reading: Sigmund Freud, "Dostoevsky and Parricide" (excerpt on the psychoanalytic interpretation of literature)	2	
		Suggested Activity: 1. Close reading and analysis of an excerpt from T. S. Eliot's "The Waste Land" 2. Group activity: Analyze a poem using the methods and characteristics of New Criticism. 3. Psychoanalytic reading: Apply Freudian concepts to a short story or novel. 4. Comparative Literary Criticism: Cross-cultural Analysis 5. Contemporary Trends in Literary Criticism 6. Practical Criticism: T.S. Eliot and I.A. Richards 7. Individual Research Project: Applying Literary Criticism Theories to Modern Texts		
V	OPEN ENDED		12	

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 18 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 48 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 12 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (10 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 18 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

Module I:

1. History of Sanskrit Poetics-S. K De
2. Literary Theory: An Introduction-Terry Eagleton
3. Readings in Chinese Literary Thought-Stephen Owen

Module II:

4. The Spectator essays- Joseph Addison and Richard Steele
5. An Essay of Dramatic Poesy -John Dryden (Excerpt)
6. What is Enlightenment? -Immanuel Kant
7. The Social Contract -Rousseau

Module III

8. Preface to Lyrical Ballads -William Wordsworth
9. Ode to a Nightingale -John Keats
10. A Defence of Poetry -P. B Shelley
11. Woman in the Nineteenth Century-Margaret Fuller

Module IV:

12. The Well Wrought Urn -Cleanth Brooks
13. Modern Fiction -Virginia Woolf
14. Against Interpretation-Susane Sontag
15. Two Aspects of Language and Two Types of Aphasic Disturbance-Roman Jakobson

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	PSO1	PSO2	PSO3	PSO4	PSO5	PSO6	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7
CO1	-	-	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO3	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO4	-	-	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO5	-	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-
CO6	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	-	-
CO7	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2
CO8	-	-	-	-	-	2	3	-	-	-	-	-	-

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:**Correlation Levels:**

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

- Class Participation/ Discussions/ Seminar (10 %)
- Quizzes/Short Assignments (10 %)
- Mid-Semester Test/Viva (10 %)
- Final Exam (70%)

Mapping of COs to Assessment Rubrics:

	Internal Exam	Assignment/Quizzes	Class Participation/ Discussion	End Semester Examinations
CO 1	✓	✓		✓
CO 2	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 3	✓			✓
CO 4	✓		✓	✓
CO 5			✓	✓
CO 6			✓	✓